

Decision: What project should I build?

Option A	Build an AI product
Option B	Build a normal portfolio website
Goal	Create something useful and impressive
Category	Project
Budget	0
Time	1 week

Analysis Results

Metric	Value
Option A Score	75/100
Option B Score	40/100
Confidence	90%
Recommended	Option A
Strength	Strong
Short-Term Regret	Medium
Long-Term Regret	Low

Strategic Reasoning

The personal goal explicitly states a desire to 'create something useful and impressive' with the critical addition that 'users actually use the project repeatedly and solve a real problem.' Option B, a normal portfolio website, serves as a static display for self-promotion and showcasing past work; it fundamentally fails to meet the criterion of a product providing repeated utility and solving a real problem for external users. While Option A, building an AI product, carries significantly higher risk due to the extremely tight 1-week timeline and 0 budget, it is the only option that directly aligns with and *can potentially fulfill* this core ambition. The recommendation is to embrace this challenging goal, but with an uncompromising focus on extreme scope management, leveraging existing free AI services, and defining a very narrow, high-impact problem to solve within the constraints. This approach, while difficult, offers the highest probability of satisfying the primary, explicit project criteria.

Build an AI product — Pros & Cons

■ Pros: Directly addresses the desire to create a useful, problem-solving product that users repeatedly engage with. • High potential for an 'impressive' outcome by demonstrating advanced skills in a cutting-edge field. • Significant learning opportunity in AI development and product scoping under tight constraints. • Can serve as a strong, unique portfolio piece if successfully executed.

■■ Cons: Extremely high risk of not being able to deliver a truly useful, impressive, and repeatedly used AI product within a 1-week timeframe and 0 budget. • Significant technical complexity and potential for scope creep leading to an unfinished or trivial product. • Reliance on free tiers of AI APIs might lead to usage limits or unexpected costs if the project gains traction. • Risk of building a novelty rather than a genuinely valuable problem-solving tool due to time pressure.

Long-Term Impact: If successful, this could be a standout project, attract significant attention, potentially lead to further development, or showcase highly sought-after skills. If unsuccessful, it still provides a valuable learning experience but

might not be a strong portfolio asset.

Opportunity Cost: Missing the opportunity to establish a comprehensive and professionally polished traditional portfolio showcasing a broader range of skills immediately. Potentially investing significant effort into a project with a high probability of not meeting its ambitious goals within the given timeframe.

Build a normal portfolio website — Pros & Cons

■ Pros: Highly achievable within the 1-week timeframe and 0 budget, ensuring a finished product. • Establishes a foundational professional online presence, crucial for career advancement. • Excellent platform to showcase existing skills, past projects, and design capabilities. • Lower technical complexity and risk compared to an AI product, leading to more predictable outcomes.

■■ Cons: Fundamentally does not align with the explicit goal of creating a product 'users actually use repeatedly and solve a real problem' in a direct, interactive sense. • While it can be impressive, it's generally less 'cutting-edge' or innovative compared to a well-executed AI product. • Primarily serves as a display for recruiters/clients, rather than an interactive utility for a broad user base. • Does not provide the same depth of learning in AI product development or problem-solving for external users.

Long-Term Impact: A well-executed portfolio website is a foundational and continually useful asset for career progression, networking, and demonstrating professional capability. It provides a stable online representation of one's work.

Opportunity Cost: Missing the chance to explore a cutting-edge technology, build a user-facing product, test an innovative idea, or develop skills directly related to AI product creation and user engagement.

Regret Predictor

Short-Term Regret Risk: Medium

Long-Term Regret Risk: Low

Reason: Choosing Option B would almost certainly lead to long-term regret, as it means definitively not pursuing the stated core goal of creating a repeatedly used, problem-solving product for external users. While Option A carries a higher risk of short-term regret if the project is significantly under-delivered, the learning experience and the attempt at the core ambition make the long-term regret risk lower, assuming a valuable learning outcome even if the product itself isn't a blockbuster success.

Future Self Simulation

If you choose: Build an AI product

1 Month: Engaged in deep learning, likely battling initial setup complexities, framework choices, and data acquisition challenges. The 'impressive' aspect is already a driver, pushing for understanding complex concepts. Progress feels slow due to the steep learning curve, but a foundational understanding of AI concepts is being established, potentially with a minimal proof-of-concept for a single feature.

6 Months: A functional Minimum Viable Product (MVP) of the AI product has likely emerged, possibly in internal testing or a very limited beta. Significant practical experience in AI model selection, data pipelines, prompt engineering, and deployment is gained. The project serves as a tangible demonstration of cutting-edge skills. Initial user feedback or technical challenges are being actively addressed, refining the product and further deepening technical expertise.

1 Year: The AI product has either found a niche, garnered modest user adoption, or failed to gain significant traction. Regardless of market success, the individual has transformed into an experienced AI developer/engineer. The project is a centerpiece of their professional portfolio, leading to high-value job opportunities in AI, successful freelance ventures, or even early-stage startup interest. The skills acquired are highly sought after and provide a significant competitive advantage in the tech landscape.

Growth: Exponential growth in technical proficiency and strategic thinking within AI, leading to accelerated career progression, increased earning potential, and a significant boost in professional network value. The individual

becomes a recognized specialist.

If you choose: Build a normal portfolio website

1 Month: A functional and aesthetically pleasing portfolio website is largely complete and live. Existing projects are being uploaded and documented. There's an immediate sense of accomplishment and a basic tool for showcasing work is now available. The learning curve for basic web development is mostly overcome.

6 Months: The portfolio website serves its intended purpose: a centralized place to display past and ongoing work. It has likely been shared with a few potential employers or collaborators. While useful, its 'impressiveness' is primarily derived from the *content* it holds, not the website itself. New skill acquisition has plateaued, and the maintenance task is minimal.

1 Year: The portfolio website continues to exist as a professional online presence. It has likely played a supporting role in job applications or networking, fulfilling a standard expectation rather than providing a significant competitive edge. The individual's career trajectory is dictated by the quality and relevance of the projects *within* the portfolio, not the act of building the site itself. It may require minor updates to stay current, but offers no substantial growth in new capabilities.

Growth: Limited direct skill growth. The website primarily acts as a vessel for showcasing existing skills. Any career growth is incremental, stemming from the quality of the projects displayed on the site, not from the creation of the site itself. It's a foundational tool, not a growth engine.

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